INTERNAL TEAM BRIEF · V4 · AUGUST 2026 · SUPERSEDES V3 (APRIL) · REFRESHED QUARTERLY · QUESTIONS: TAYLOR

# One ICP. Two operating companies. One founder-led foundry.

We don't run three random companies. We run an umbrella with two operating businesses, Product (Rollup) and Services (CoverPanda Services), plus an adjacent founder-led entity, **Franchise Foundry** (the evolution of B&B Management), that operates brands, does deals, and funnels franchise systems into both. One ICP across all three: the franchisor. Since April: the market priced our category with real money, the ICP got sharper, and the foundry got its full-time operator.

## CoverPanda · the umbrella

Two operating companies, one ICP, one game · CEO Taylor Byington

↓ the two operating companies inside

NO. 01 · PRODUCT OPCO

### Rollup

Vertical AI SaaS + embedded payments + the data layer. The platform every persona logs into, and the compliance ladder we're climbing. Domain owner · Kayden Thomson

NO. 02 · BACK-OFFICE OPCO

### CoverPanda Services

AI-native back-office. CFO/advisory at the brand level; bookkeeping and adjacent services for the franchisees underneath. CEO · Jared Nielsen

⇅ ADJACENT · ARMS-LENGTH · BRANDS FUNNEL IN · STACK + BACK-OFFICE FULFILL

ADJACENT · FOUNDER-LED

### Franchise Foundry

Operator portfolio, acquisitions and brand plays, advisory + capital connect, the audience engine (the Eight Figures podcast). CEO & co-founder · Shideler Bennett. Structure in definition.

FOUNDATIONS · WHY THIS STRUCTURE

# Same three reasons as April. The market spent four months agreeing.

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|---|---|
| Reason 01 · Two opcos, one buyer | Rollup and CoverPanda Services are sold to the same franchisor with one sales motion. The sentence stays the sentence: "We automate your royalties and give you the financial insights to coach your franchisees." Exit-ready is where the relationship goes; the sentence is where it starts. |
| Reason 02 · The foundry is a different motion | Founder-led, in-person, deals and operating credibility. Different rhythm, different deliverables, different risk. Adjacent, not absorbed, keeps the model honest. New since April: it is also the audience engine, and that matters more than ever (see the market moment below). |
| Reason 03 · Different valuation realities | Software earns one multiple, services another, advisory/portfolio a third. Cleanly separated entities preserve every dollar of value each creates. |

## How the multiples shake out

INSIDE THE UMBRELLA

### Rollup

Vertical AI SaaS + embedded payments. Compounds with retention, attach, payments velocity. The long-term equity story.

10–15× SaaS multiple

INSIDE THE UMBRELLA

### CoverPanda Services

AI-native back-office. Real revenue, real margin; AI leverage compresses cost and the data feeds the platform.

4–8× · services + AI premium

ADJACENT

### Franchise Foundry

Hybrid: portfolio NAV + advisory + deal economics. Strategic value is founder-led relationships, audience, and capital network.

Hybrid · per-engagement / per-unit

**The blended prize, added since April:** the platform multiple (12–18×) is earned only at ~65% blended gross margin with product at half the mix. That is why the services margin path and the product mix shift are everyone's lever, not one entity's.

## The market moment (new since April)

Delightree raised $25M from Accel as the ops OS for franchising: 6,000+ locations, ~20x revenue in two years. Haven crossed $15M ARR as an AI-native accounting firm in about three years. One proved the vertical buys at venture scale, one proved the engine we run scales fast. **Neither**

**holds the money-and-compliance layer: the books, royalties on real revenue, consolidated financials, and the FDD-grade record a franchise system legally cannot skip.** We are the intersection, and the window to own it is roughly 12 to 24 months. Neither of them has a founder-led narrative from inside the space. We do, and the foundry is where it lives.

# Domain ownership over hierarchy. Everyone heard, one decider.

| LEADERSHIP | SEAT |
|---|---|
| Taylor Byington | CEO of CoverPanda / Rollup: strategy and the final voice after everyone is heard, the fundraise and investor lane, product management with Kayden, flagship co-sell, strategic CPA relationships, the operating cadence. Co-founder at Franchise Foundry, with the specifics of that seat structured within the concept to align with internal needs and requirements. |
| Kayden Thomson | CTO & co-founder. Domain owner of Rollup: architecture, the data layer, integrations, the activation machine, the CFO stack and compliance-layer roadmap. |
| Jared Nielsen | CEO of CoverPanda Services: the P&L, delivery, pricing, the 11/10 standard, the 45→65% margin path, the CFO product-customer seat (his feedback IS the product spec). |
| Shideler Bennett | CEO & co-founder of Franchise Foundry: brand relationships, deals and partnerships, the capital network, the audience engine. Founding partner across the umbrella's growth motion; the brand relationships he holds stay his. |

| INSIDE EACH ENTITY | PEOPLE |
|---|---|
| Rollup | Kayden Thomson (CTO, domain owner) · Matt McMurry (founding engineer: payments, POS integrations, closing portal) · Taylor (product management, roadmap) |
| CoverPanda Services | Jared Nielsen (CEO, Head of Accounting) · Brad Dixon (staff accountant) · Zac Walker (staff accountant) · VA delivery layer supporting the hybrid model |
| Franchise Foundry | Shideler Bennett (CEO & co-founder) · Taylor Byington (co-founder) · Rachel Dixon (brand president, portfolio operations) · area managers + VA team running day-to-day portfolio ops |

**Roles, stated simply:** Taylor is CEO at CoverPanda/Rollup. Shideler is CEO at Franchise Foundry, and he remains a partner on this team: the evolution changes his seat, not his membership. Together the two run a joint motion closer to a studio than a reporting line, and the time spent on

Foundry brands, deals, and audience doubles as CoverPanda's most credible go-to-market, measured, not assumed.

01 · ROLLUP · THE PRODUCT COMPANY

# The operating system for the franchisor's money.

**What we believe:** owning the financial identity layer of a franchise system is fundamentally larger than owning its ops checklist. Toast was never just a POS; we are never just a workspace. Since April this belief got a sharper name: **ops companies own the checklist, we own the FDD.** The books beneath every unit, royalties computed on real POS revenue, consolidated financials, and, at the top of the ladder, the annual FDD renewal workflow. Own that and we are structurally unremovable.

## The product surfaces, with August status

| SURFACE | STATUS · WHAT CHANGED SINCE APRIL |
|---|---|
| Brand Workspace | The franchisor's control room: connections, payments, brand reporting, consolidated financials. LIVE and the center of the activation standard. |
| Unit Workspace | The franchisee's home, connected to the brand above. LIVE · the invitations motion is the current fix (it stalled while backend activation surged). |
| Accountant Workspace | **New since April, and the August star: it beat the tooling our own services team was using.** V1 goes into the first partner firm's hands this month. The product side of the firm channel. V1 SHIPPING |
| Closing Portal | Broker → brand → franchisee end-to-end. FIRST REAL FRANCHISE AGREEMENT EXECUTED (Rio Açaí). Powers the partner/broker channel. |
| Data Rooms | Live but deliberately deprioritized: the Q2 lesson was that diligence tooling sprawls. It waits behind activation on the roadmap. |
| Onboarding Rooms · Enterprise | On the map, gated behind the 300-unit bar and the compliance ladder. |

## Monetization layers

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| SaaS subscriptions | $249/mo brand + $46/unit/mo, the pricing atoms everything models from. |
| Embedded payments | Royalties on real revenue, collected on our rails: live with first brands, Stella's switching collection Sept 1. The bill.com/Ramp layer for franchising is the build direction (Mindbody ★ Square ★ Crisp ★ Stripe ★ live or covered). |

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| AI add-ons | Reports and announcements engine in production; insights on the data we hold. |
| Marketplace | Ratified as the three-sided end-state, **explicitly frozen behind the 2026 gates** (units live, firm intros). It earns its build; it doesn't get it for free. |

## One ICP, three motions (updated)

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| Direct | Outbound to the growth-stage franchisor's finance seat: 25–50 units open, 50–100 sold, POS on the coverage list. Pipeline standard: demo-taken, dollar value in HubSpot, 5 verified demos a week. |
| Channel · the firm lane | **New since April and now first-class:** accountant firms get the workspace free, connect entities at wholesale, and open brand doors for consolidated financials. Plus brokers/FSOs (Sidekick renewed), attorneys (Akerman live), and partner referrals under the 15% sell-cost budget. |
| PLG | financial-os.coverpanda.co self-serve front door (instrument it: it is the one unmeasured funnel). |

## OKRs, reset for the gates

2026 product plan: $750K collected ($1M stretch) inside the blended company target. April's $2M-per-entity framing consolidated in July into one blended company number; everything here models from collected dollars.

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| Objective 01 · Activate | 300 adopted units by Sep 30 · 100% of signed-brand units within each brand's activation window · batch motion (a brand connects 30–200 units in one move; Melty in ~3 weeks is the proof the 6-week era is over). |
| Objective 02 · Collect | Monthly product collections $12K → $20K Aug → Dec, every rung an existing customer: fees fixed, Deka's payment method, DonutNV's remaining units, Melty, Swig connect. |
| Objective 03 · Arm the channel | Accountant workspace v1 live with two firms by Sep 30 · brand consolidation reporting sellable by Oct 31 · royalty rails on one more POS. |

## Q3 priorities

1 Melty live in weeks, not months: the activation-velocity proof point.

2 Accountant workspace v1 into Terry's firm with services alongside; firm #2 following.

3 Invoice 2-way sync: unblocks Homefront, 2nd Family, and Melty at once.

4 DonutNV health debt closed with the Square-pipeline template (77 paying, 14 healthy is the biggest churn risk on the board).

5 Measurement fixed: Stripe SaaS connector reconnected, invitations motion restarted, financial-os instrumented.

## Asks & risks

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| Risk · adoption vs usage | Units connected surged while weekly active users fell. Machine activation without human onboarding is churn on a delay. Fix: invitations restarted, the fan-board wow per account. |
| Risk · building past the buyer | The Q2 data-room lesson stands: we ship what activates, sells, or makes the CFO's job easier. Everything else logs and waits. |
| Asks | Services: keep every miss logged as a Linear issue (permanent QA channel). Sales motion: firm-routed and Foundry-routed brands are tier-zero. Everyone: no new build commitments outside the Q3 list. |

# The cash engine, and the doctrine that keeps it one.

**The doctrine holds from April:** Services exists to take inbound and convert it to value at the 11/10 standard. We do not fund outbound from scratch; the umbrella motion and the foundry feed the funnel, and services owns the close on what arrives: **50% conversion on brand-referred franchisees is the standard, 75% is the excellence bar.** New since April: the margin path is named and owned: 45% → 65% gross margin, with elected growth-burn stated quarterly, because the blended platform multiple is earned there.

## What we deliver · two altitudes, one hybrid model

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| Brand altitude (the wedge) | Plug-in CFO and advisory: cash flow, unit economics, royalty discipline, consolidated reporting, exit-readiness. ~$950+/mo brand-level where sold. Customer zero for the product's CFO stack. |
| Franchisee altitude (the attach) | Bookkeeping $450/mo · payroll attach (~15% of accounts, ~$8.4K/yr all-in) · tax and insurance as future arms under the umbrella template. |
| The hybrid engine | AI does the repetitive 70%, humans hold the judgment 30%, and the platform compounds every transaction. Since April this got its proof: the accountant workspace our product team built now beats the tooling our own delivery team used. |

**The expectation lesson, earned the hard way this summer:** a client should never be surprised by a bill or a filing. Bookkeeping vs accounting vs tax vs CPA gets defined for every client, day one, and proactive flags (sales tax above all) are part of the deliverable, not a courtesy.

## How customers enter (the funnels, now measured)

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| Umbrella sales motion | Brand lands via the direct motion; services co-quoted on every brand deal; attach standard ≥ 50% of referred franchisees. |
| The firm channel | **New first-class funnel:** partner accounting firms connect their books of business at wholesale. Terry is firm #1 (74 units, onboarding starting now, 100% by year-end the target); firm #2 named from the Akerman summit. |
| Foundry funnel | Brands the foundry advises or operates route here for back-office, on arms-length terms, same SLA, no special discounts. |
| Onboarding-time conversion | Every new unit a signed brand opens needs books from day one; we are standing there as preferred vendor. |

## KPIs

2026 services plan: $1.25M collected ($1.5M stretch). The path runs through collections discipline, the firm channel (Terry first, 100% by year-end), and the 50%/75% conversion standard on referred franchisees.

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| Referred-lead conversion | 50% standard · 75% excellence bar · tracked uniformly per brand |
| Past-due MRR | Under $9K by Aug 31, then held |
| Time to first value | Franchisee books live < 7 days · brand engagement < 14 days · onboarding boring by design |
| Margin path | 45% → 65% gross, elected growth-burn stated quarterly |
| SLA + the 11/10 standard | Misses get postmortems and a Linear issue; opinions don't |

## Q3 priorities & asks

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|---|---|
| 1 · Collect | Dunning motion on the 26 past-due subs · ACH settlements verified · tail decision made. |
| 2 · Terry to live | Firm #1 onboarding in batches, the portal as her client experience, 100% by year-end. |
| 3 · The attach machine | Every new brand win co-quoted; every referred franchisee tracked against the 50%/75% bar; flawless handoffs (the 2nd Family process is the new normal). |
| Asks | Product: invoice 2-way sync and native services data in the brand workspace. Sales motion: services co-quoted on every deal. Foundry: routed brands arrive with expectations pre-set. |

03 · FRANCHISE FOUNDRY · ADJACENT, FOUNDER-LED

# B&B, evolved. The front door became a foundry.

April's principle stands: *brands come for advisory and capital; they leave with a tech stack, a back-office, and a path to exit-readiness, fulfilled by Rollup and Services on the back end.* What evolved: the entity now has a full-time operator. **Shideler leads Franchise Foundry as CEO & co-founder**, with Taylor as co-founder. It operates the portfolio, hunts and structures deals, and runs the audience engine that neither Delightree nor Haven can copy: founder-led credibility from inside the space.

**Structure, stated plainly while it finalizes:** Foundry's internal terms are being papered now and are **structured to involvement and capacity**: Shideler heads the entity full-time as CEO; Taylor's seat reflects a co-founder's involvement, not an operator's; alignment on the existing portfolio carries forward. And one deliberate change from the April model: **incentives to product and services now sit with Shideler individually (commissions and equity in his own name), not with the entity.** The entities themselves stay arms-length and commercially coupled, which keeps every layer's books and story clean. And to say it plainly: **Shideler remains part of this team.** The evolution changes the seat, not the membership.

## The advisory model · the four conversations (unchanged, sharpened)

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|---|---|
| 01 · Standardization | "Help us run the franchise like a real franchise." Royalty discipline, onboarding cadence, brand reporting. Resourced by Rollup's closing portal and brand workspace. |
| 02 · Back-office | "Plug in our financial leadership." Fulfilled by CoverPanda Services on arms-length terms, same SLA as everyone. |
| 03 · Capital | "Connect us to the right partner." The PE and capital network, curated, relationship-managed by Shideler with Taylor. |
| 04 · Exit-readiness | "Get us to a liquidity event." Clean books, proven unit economics, positioned for acquisition: the thesis, delivered as an engagement. |
| 05 · Operate & acquire (new) | The foundry's own moves: portfolio operations, concept conversions (the Bagel Run/Goleta class of idea), distressed opportunities, international entries via the attorney network. Every one runs the CoverPanda stack and becomes a public case study. |

## Where revenue comes from

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| Foundry-side | Portfolio operations and management economics · advisory engagements · deal and capital-connect economics, case by case. |

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| Umbrella-side, attributable | Every foundry brand is a Rollup + Services candidate, tracked and attributed: referrals at standard rates, sourced-revenue commissions to Shideler individually on what he brings. |

## Flagship initiatives

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| The Eight Figures podcast | The founder-led audience engine for the franchise space: operators, deals, and the money behind brands. It lives in the foundry, and CoverPanda plugs in commercially the same arms-length way everything else does, sponsorship being the obvious example. |
| The content engine | CoverPanda produces weekly material; Shideler publishes to the audience the space already trusts. |
| Conferences & panels | The Akerman circuit and international-brand events: the in-person funnel that produces warm brand conversations. |

## Team

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|---|---|
| Team | Shideler Bennett (CEO & co-founder) · Taylor Byington (co-founder) · Rachel Dixon (brand president, portfolio ops) · area managers + VA team on day-to-day. |
| Portfolio | 12 operating units under management. The portfolio is the credibility: we operate what we advise on. |

## KPIs & Q3 priorities

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| KPIs | Brand intros per quarter into the umbrella · sourced activated ARR · referrals both directions · content cadence and audience growth · portfolio operating discipline (labor, cash, break-even progress). |
| 1 | Terms landed in one session and papered with counsel alongside the ratified structure. |
| 2 | The funnel made measurable: stage gates, referral counts, revenue attribution. |
| 3 | Content engine live: weekly material produced by CoverPanda, posted by the person the space already trusts. |

## Asks & risks

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|---|---|
| Risk · optics | Operating units inside a space we sell into is a delicate dance. Clean separation, transparent arms-length pricing, and honest external positioning are the guardrails. |

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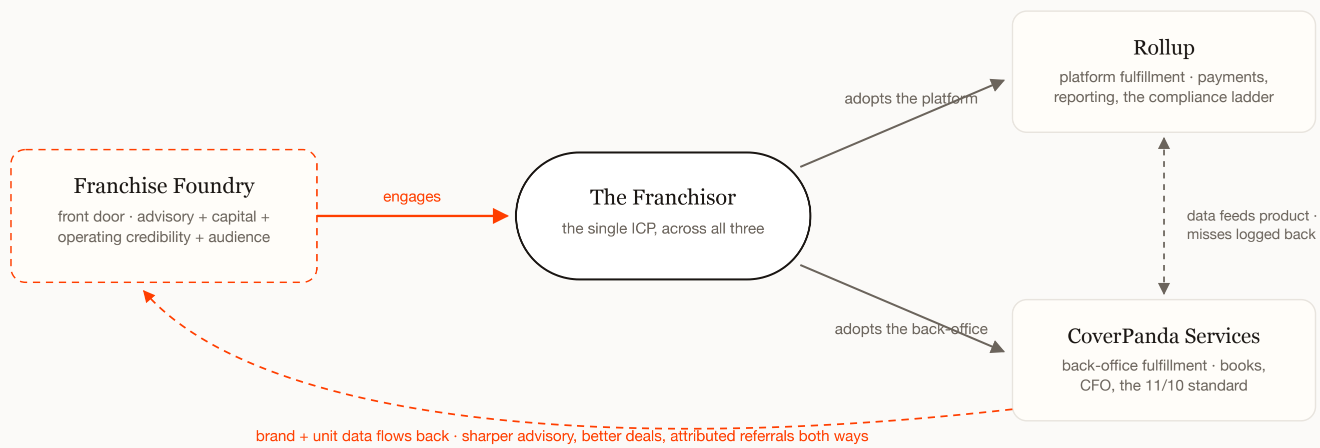
|---|---|
| Risk · funnel or freelance | If the foundry engages brands but doesn't feed the umbrella, the strategic logic breaks. The KPIs exist so this is visible monthly, not debated yearly. |
| Asks | Network: brands looking at standardization, capital, or exit-prep go to Shideler. Product/Services: foundry-routed brands are tier-zero, same SLA, no special discounts. |
| | |

THE SYSTEM · HOW THE THREE CONNECT

# Read it as a loop, not a chart.




| | |
|---|---|
| Loop 01 | Foundry engages a brand on advisory, capital, or operations → the brand needs a tech stack (Rollup) and a back-office (Services) → both attach, attributed. |
| Loop 02 | Services delivers on the platform → every miss becomes a Linear issue, every win a sales reference → the data makes the product smarter. |
| Loop 03 | Brand and unit data from the umbrella sharpens foundry advisory → fewer brands, deeper insight, better deals. |
| Loop 04 (new) | Accountant firms connect their books → units activate in batches → firms open brand doors for consolidated financials → brands feed services → the firm's practice grows on our rails. |

> *Clear lanes don't mean separate games. The logos the motion signs hand services their units. The books services keeps make the product smarter. Everything product ships makes the next sale easier. And everything the foundry touches funnels home.*

## The one game · what we are all playing for

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|---|---|
| The year | Company **$2.0M target · $2.5M stretch** (Services $1.25M/$1.5M · Product $750K/$1M) from the reconciled **$733K collected baseline**. The path is carried by named moves with owners: the 300-unit activation bar, Terry to 100%, Swig's connect, the firm channel, and the 20-logo blend. |
| The gates | Sep 30: Swig royalty rail + 300 adopted units · Oct 31: first firm-sourced brand intro · Dec 15: the decision gate, read together on bank data. |

## How we run, week to week (updated)

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|---|---|
| Daily | Standup: live feedback, not Slack threads. |
| Friday | The scoreboard, pulled not estimated (Stripe, Mercury, HubSpot, PostHog, Linear, Apollo): recap against the numbers, next week's priorities, the two raving-fan boards. If a number isn't from a pull, it doesn't go in a report. |
| Monthly | Partner meeting with financials pre-circulated · product adoption + feedback review across entities. |
| Quarterly | OKR reset · gate checks · resource allocation. This brief refreshes on the same cadence. |

## What we need from each other

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|---|---|
| From Rollup | Ship what activates. Treat services-routed, firm-routed, and foundry-routed brands as tier-zero. |
| From Services | Hold the 11/10 bar and the 50%/75% conversion standard. Every miss logged to the platform. Collections until past-due stays under the bar. |
| From the Foundry | Funnel, don't freelance. Every engagement attributable, every stack need routed home. |
| From all of us | One ICP, one game. If an ask routes through more than one entity, name the lead and don't double-pitch. Q3 priorities are on these pages; new work waits unless it unblocks them. Surface friction in the room, not in DMs. |

**One ICP. Two operating companies. One founder-led foundry.** If everyone in the room can finish that sentence the same way, we're going to win.

Internal team brief V4 · August 2026 · supersedes V3 (April) · Foundry terms in definition; structural terms ratify with counsel · refreshed quarterly · questions: Taylor · not for distribution